

Resume Building

Placement Training Program

ATS-Friendly Formatting

Many companies filter incoming resumes through an Applicant Tracking System (ATS) before a human ever reads them — software that parses the resume text and screens for relevant keywords and structure. ATS-friendly formatting means: a standard, single-column layout (multi-column layouts and text inside images/graphics often parse incorrectly or get skipped entirely), standard section headings ('Experience,' 'Education,' 'Skills' rather than creative alternatives an ATS may not recognize), and a simple, widely-compatible file format (typically PDF or .docx, following the specific employer's stated preference).

Highlighting Projects

For students without extensive work experience, projects are often the strongest content on a resume — but only if described in a way that conveys real substance rather than a vague title. A strong project entry states what was built, the specific technologies/skills used, and — critically — the result or impact, not just the activity ('Built a full-stack attendance tracking app used by 200+ students across 3 colleges' communicates far more than 'Worked on a web application').

Quantifying Achievements

Wherever genuinely possible, achievements should include a number that gives a reader real scale — percentage improvement, time saved, number of users, size of a dataset processed. 'Improved page load time' is vague; 'Reduced page load time by 40% by optimizing image loading' is concrete and memorable to a reader skimming dozens of resumes. When a precise number genuinely isn't available (common for coursework or class projects), a scope indicator (team size, project duration, dataset size) still adds useful, credible concreteness.

LinkedIn Optimization

A LinkedIn profile serves a different purpose than a resume — it's searchable by recruiters and should be optimized accordingly: a headline that states role/specialization clearly rather than just a generic job title, a complete 'About' summary written in a slightly more conversational tone than a resume allows, and skills listed that genuinely match how recruiters search (industry-standard terms, not internal jargon). Keeping the resume and LinkedIn profile broadly consistent in the facts they state — dates, titles, project descriptions — matters too, since recruiters routinely cross-check the two, and unexplained inconsistencies raise questions.

Learn More

Indeed Career Guide — Resume Writing

<https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/resumes-cover-letters>

LinkedIn Learning — Profile Optimization

<https://www.linkedin.com/learning/>

Harvard Business Review — Resumes & Job Search

<https://hbr.org/topic/subject/job-search>